

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7)

Chapter 9: From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	9 — From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Watch the classic traps: a country with a king CAN be a democracy (the UK is a constitutional monarchy and a parliamentary democracy); India is a PARLIAMENTARY democracy even though it has a President - real executive power is with the prime minister and council of ministers; elections ALONE do not make a democracy (it also needs equality, rights and an independent judiciary); 'democracy' and 'republic' are NOT identical; and the majority cannot simply vote away anyone's fundamental rights. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

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1. A 'government' is best described as:
(A) the set of institutions through which a country is run
(B) a single elected leader acting entirely alone
(C) the army that defends a country's borders (D) the group of all citizens who vote
 2. Which of these is a core job of any government?
(A) running every shop and farm directly
(B) making rules, carrying them out, and ensuring they are followed
(C) choosing each family's religion (D) writing the country's songs and poems
 3. 'Every country has a government, but governments are not all the same' means that:
(A) only democracies count as real governments
(B) all countries are run somehow, but the kind of government varies
(C) every government works in exactly the same way
(D) a country can exist with no government at all
 4. Making the laws of a country is the _____ function of government.

- (A) executive
- (B) legislative
- (C) judicial
- (D) ceremonial

5. Carrying out and implementing the laws is the _____ function.

- (A) legislative
- (B) judicial
- (C) executive
- (D) electoral

6. Settling disputes and ensuring that laws are followed is the _____ function.

- (A) judicial
- (B) legislative
- (C) executive
- (D) advisory

7. A court strikes down an order because it breaks the law. Which function of government is at work?

- (A) legislative
- (B) executive
- (C) judicial
- (D) ceremonial

8. The chapter says one government differs from another based on questions such as:

- (A) only which country is the largest
- (B) only which country has the biggest army
- (C) only which country is the oldest
- (D) who decides 'this is the government', how it is formed, its parts, and what it works for

9. The deepest question separating a democracy from a dictatorship is:

- (A) how many people live in the country
- (B) who holds power and how the government is chosen
- (C) which language the people speak
- (D) how much land the country has

10. 'Democracy' literally means:

- (A) rule of one king
- (B) rule of the priests
- (C) rule of the people
- (D) rule of the army

11. In a democracy, the ultimate source of power is:

- (A) a hereditary king
- (B) the people, who choose their representatives
- (C) a single religious leader
- (D) the wealthiest families

12. The phrase 'rule of the people' implies that, in a democracy, leaders are:

- (A) appointed for life by the previous ruler
- (B) chosen by and answerable to the people
- (C) selected only by the army
- (D) born into the role

13. The school student-committee story is used in the chapter mainly to explain:

- (A) how to win a sports match
- (B) how taxes are collected
- (C) how representation works - choosing a few to act for many
- (D) how a king inherits a throne

14. A 'representative' is:

- (A) a person who rules because of his birth
- (B) a person chosen to act or decide on behalf of others
- (C) the richest person in a group
- (D) a judge who settles disputes

15. Choosing class representatives instead of every student deciding everything is most like:

- (A) representative democracy
- (B) absolute monarchy
- (C) theocracy
- (D) dictatorship

16. Which is a fundamental principle of democracy?

- (A) power passed down within one family
- (B) equality of all citizens
- (C) rule by religious law alone
- (D) decisions made by a few wealthy people

17. 'Universal adult franchise' means:

- (A) only landowners may vote
- (B) only men may vote
- (C) only members of the government may vote
- (D) every citizen above a certain age has the right to vote

18. 'Suffrage' is:

- (A) the duty to pay taxes
- (B) the power to make laws
- (C) the right to vote in elections
- (D) the office of a judge

19. An 'independent judiciary' matters in a democracy because it:

- (A) always rules in the government's favour
- (B) is controlled by the ruling party
- (C) only gives advice to the king
- (D) can decide cases fairly, even against the government, ensuring laws are followed

20. Why are fundamental rights important in a democracy?

- (A) they let the majority do absolutely anything it wants
- (B) they belong only to the rulers
- (C) they protect citizens' freedoms even from the government and the majority
- (D) they apply only during elections

21. 'Accountability' in a democracy means the government is:

- (A) free from any questioning by citizens
- (B) answerable only to a foreign power
- (C) answerable to the people who elected it
- (D) able to ignore the courts

22. In a 'direct democracy', the people:

- (A) decide on issues themselves, often by voting directly
- (B) never vote at all
- (C) obey a hereditary king
- (D) let a small group decide everything

23. A 'referendum' is:

- (A) an election of representatives to a parliament
- (B) a decision made by judges
- (C) a law made by a king
- (D) a direct vote in which all citizens decide a single question themselves

24. In a 'representative democracy', citizens:

- (A) vote directly on every single law themselves
- (B) have no vote at all
- (C) elect representatives to make decisions on their behalf
- (D) inherit their seats in parliament

25. Most large modern countries use representative rather than direct democracy mainly because:

- (A) it is impractical for millions of citizens to vote directly on every decision
- (B) citizens are not allowed to have any opinions
- (C) direct democracy is illegal worldwide
- (D) representatives are always kings

26. India is a:

- (A) presidential democracy
- (B) absolute monarchy
- (C) theocracy
- (D) parliamentary democracy

27. The claim 'India is a presidential democracy because it has a President' is wrong because:

- (A) India actually has no President at all
- (B) real executive power lies with the prime minister and council of ministers, who must keep the Lok Sabha's confidence
- (C) India is ruled by a hereditary king
- (D) the President of India is elected directly by all voters

28. The USA is the chapter's example of a:

- (A) parliamentary democracy
- (B) constitutional monarchy
- (C) presidential democracy
- (D) oligarchy

29. A key difference between parliamentary and presidential democracy is that, in a parliamentary system:

- (A) the head of government is elected separately and is independent of the legislature
- (B) there are never any elections
- (C) the head of government is drawn from the legislature and must keep its confidence
- (D) a king makes all the laws

30. In India, real executive power is held by the:

- (A) President acting alone
- (B) prime minister and the council of ministers
- (C) Chief Justice
- (D) hereditary royal family

31. In the USA's presidential system, the president is:

- (A) chosen by and answerable to the legislature
- (B) elected and works independently of the legislature
- (C) a hereditary monarch
- (D) appointed by the judges

32. The three organs of government are the:

- (A) legislature, executive and judiciary
- (B) army, police and courts
- (C) king, council and priests
- (D) voters, parties and media

33. 'Separation of powers' means the three organs:

- (A) are all controlled by one single person
- (B) never communicate with one another at all
- (C) are abolished in a democracy
- (D) work independently and do not interfere in each other's functions

34. Why does separation of powers help protect democracy?

- (A) it lets the executive control the courts
- (B) it stops any one organ from gaining total control and abusing power
- (C) it gives all power to the legislature
- (D) it removes the need for any laws

35. If a country's ruler controls the lawmakers, the enforcers and the judges all at once, it most clearly lacks:

- (A) a national flag
- (B) separation of powers
- (C) a large population
- (D) any rivers or mountains

36. A 'monarchy' is a government ruled by:

- (A) elected representatives
- (B) religious leaders
- (C) a small group of wealthy families
- (D) a monarch (king or queen), usually inheriting the position within the family

37. In an 'absolute monarchy' (like Saudi Arabia), the king:

- (A) truly holds and exercises ruling power
- (B) has only nominal, ceremonial power
- (C) is elected every five years
- (D) is chosen by the courts

38. In a 'constitutional monarchy' (like the UK), the king or queen:

- (A) holds all real power and personally makes every law
- (B) is elected by the people every term
- (C) has mostly nominal power while an elected parliament makes the laws
- (D) does not exist at all

39. The claim 'a country with a king or queen cannot be a democracy' is:

- (A) always true, because any monarch blocks democracy
- (B) true only for absolute monarchies that are democracies
- (C) false, because the UK has no monarch at all
- (D) false - a constitutional monarchy like the UK is a parliamentary democracy with a nominal king

- 40.** The UK shows that the same country can be:
(A) only ever a pure absolute monarchy (B) a democracy that has banned all elections
(C) both a democracy and a monarchy at once (a constitutional monarchy)
(D) a country with no government
- 41.** A 'theocracy' is a government in which a country is ruled by:
(A) an elected parliament
(B) the rules of religion and by religious leaders
(C) a hereditary king with only nominal power (D) a small group of wealthy families
- 42.** A 'dictatorship' is a government in which:
(A) one person or a small group holds absolute power with no limits from a constitution or law
(B) power is shared among elected representatives
(C) the people vote directly on every issue (D) a monarch's power is purely ceremonial
- 43.** The word 'theocracy' uses the Greek root 'kratos', the same root found in:
(A) 'democracy' (B) 'monarchy'
(C) 'oligarchy' (D) 'anarchy'
- 44.** A dictatorship differs most sharply from a democracy in that it:
(A) holds the largest elections in the world (B) always protects minority rights
(C) has no real limits on the ruler's power and no genuine accountability to the people
(D) has the most independent courts
- 45.** An 'oligarchy' is a government in which:
(A) a small, powerful group - often wealthy families - makes the important decisions
(B) every adult citizen votes on the laws (C) a single king inherits power
(D) religious leaders rule by sacred law
- 46.** The word 'oligarchy' comes from Greek roots meaning:
(A) 'few' and 'to rule' (B) 'people' and 'power'
(C) 'one' and 'rule' (D) 'god' and 'power'
- 47.** The chapter warns that even a real democracy can drift toward oligarchy if:
(A) too many ordinary people vote (B) the courts become independent
(C) fundamental rights are well protected
(D) a small powerful group gains too much control
- 48.** The 'Peek into History' shows that the idea of the ruled choosing their rulers is:
(A) brand-new, invented in the 21st century (B) found only outside India
(C) ancient, with examples from early India, Greece and Rome
(D) impossible before modern times

49. The Lichchhavi clan, an early example of people choosing their leaders, belonged to which mahajanapada?

- (A) the Vajji
- (B) the Magadha empire of the Mauryas
- (C) the Chola kingdom of the south
- (D) the Kushana empire of the northwest

50. The Uttaramerur inscriptions, evidence of an ancient election system, are linked to the:

- (A) Guptas
- (B) Mauryas
- (C) Indo-Greeks
- (D) Cholas

51. The Uttaramerur inscriptions are valuable because they show that:

- (A) organised elections to choose representatives existed in India long ago
- (B) India never held any elections before modern times
- (C) only kings ever held power in India
- (D) elections were invented in Greece alone

52. Together, the Vajji republic and the republics of Greece and Rome show that:

- (A) only one civilisation ever tried democracy
- (B) democracy began only in the 20th century
- (C) republics never existed in the ancient world
- (D) republican and democratic ideas arose in several ancient civilisations

53. A 'republic' is a form of government in which the head of state is:

- (A) always a king who inherits the throne
- (B) elected, not a hereditary monarch
- (C) chosen by religious leaders
- (D) appointed by a foreign country

54. Why are 'democracy' and 'republic' NOT just two words for the same thing?

- (A) they mean exactly the same and always describe the same country
- (B) a republic forbids all voting
- (C) democracy is rule BY the people; a republic specifically means the head of state is elected, not hereditary
- (D) a democracy must always have a king

55. India is best described as a:

- (A) democracy that keeps a hereditary king
- (B) theocracy ruled by religious law
- (C) absolute monarchy
- (D) democratic republic - rule by the people, with an elected (not hereditary) head of state

56. The United Kingdom shows that a country can be a democracy while still:

- (A) banning all elections forever
- (B) being ruled entirely by religious law
- (C) having no parliament at all
- (D) keeping a monarch as a nominal head of state

57. The claim 'holding an election automatically makes a country a real democracy' is wrong because a genuine democracy also needs:

- (A) equality, freedom of speech, fundamental rights and an independent judiciary
- (B) only a very large army
- (C) only a hereditary king
- (D) nothing more than a single vote

58. The idea that 'in a democracy the majority can do absolutely anything it wants' is mistaken because democracy:

- (A) lets the majority remove anyone's fundamental rights by a vote
- (B) gives the majority control of the courts
- (C) has no rules at all
- (D) protects minority and individual rights and limits power through a constitution and separation of powers

59. Despite its problems, the chapter says democracy matters and is:

- (A) the rarest form of government on Earth
- (B) a system that no country actually uses
- (C) identical to a dictatorship
- (D) the most popular form of government in the world today

60. A country holds votes, but a single wealthy family controls the courts, the lawmakers and the press. This country is best described as:

- (A) an oligarchy wearing the appearance of a democracy
- (B) a healthy, full democracy
- (C) a constitutional monarchy
- (D) a direct democracy

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 9: From the Rulers to the Ruled: Types of Governments

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	A	11	B	21	C	31	B	41	B	51	A
2	B	12	B	22	A	32	A	42	A	52	D
3	B	13	C	23	D	33	D	43	A	53	B
4	B	14	B	24	C	34	B	44	C	54	C
5	C	15	A	25	A	35	B	45	A	55	D
6	A	16	B	26	D	36	D	46	A	56	D
7	C	17	D	27	B	37	A	47	D	57	A
8	D	18	C	28	C	38	C	48	C	58	D
9	B	19	D	29	C	39	D	49	A	59	D
10	C	20	C	30	B	40	C	50	D	60	A

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

- (A)** A government is the set of institutions that make rules, carry them out and ensure they are followed. It is not one leader alone, the army, or the whole electorate.
- (B)** Government's core is the legislative, executive and judicial functions - making, enforcing and upholding rules. It does not run all businesses, dictate religion, or write art.
- (B)** Every country has some government, yet they differ in how power is held and used. Not only democracies count, they are not identical, and a country needs some government to run.
- (B)** Making rules is the legislative function. Carrying them out is executive, ensuring they are followed is judicial, and 'ceremonial' is not one of the three functions.
- (C)** Putting laws into action is the executive function. Making laws is legislative, judging disputes is judicial, and 'electoral' is not one of the functions here.

- 6. (A)** Ensuring laws are obeyed and settling disputes is the judicial function, the work of the courts. The others make or carry out laws.
- 7. (C)** A court judging whether something follows the law is the judicial function. Lawmaking is legislative and enforcing is executive.
- 8. (D)** Governments differ by who holds power, how they form, their parts and their aims - not merely size, army, or age.
- 9. (B)** The key difference is who holds power and how rulers are chosen. Population, language and land do not by themselves decide the type of government.
- 10. (C)** Democracy means 'rule of the people' (from Greek demos + kratos). One-king rule is monarchy, priestly rule is theocracy, and army rule is not democracy.
- 11. (B)** In a democracy the people are the source of power and choose their representatives. A king, a religious head, or rich families holding power describe other forms.
- 12. (B)** 'Rule of the people' means leaders are chosen by and accountable to the people, not life-appointed, army-selected, or born to rule.
- 13. (C)** The committee story illustrates representation: students choose a few to act on behalf of all. It is not about sports, taxes, or royal inheritance.
- 14. (B)** A representative is chosen to act for others. Birth-rule is monarchy, wealth-rule is oligarchy, and a dispute-settler is a judge.
- 15. (A)** Electing a few to act for all mirrors representative democracy. The other forms concentrate power in a king, religious leaders, or a single ruler.
- 16. (B)** Equality is a core democratic principle. Family-inherited power, religious rule and decisions by a wealthy few describe monarchy, theocracy and oligarchy.
- 17. (D)** Universal adult franchise grants every citizen above a set age the right to vote. Limiting the vote to landowners, men, or the government denies this principle.
- 18. (C)** Suffrage (Latin suffragium) is the right to vote. Tax-paying, lawmaking and judging are different things.
- 19. (D)** An independent judiciary judges fairly, even against the government, upholding the law. A judiciary that always favours the government, is party-controlled, or merely advises a king is not independent.
- 20. (C)** Fundamental rights guard citizens' freedoms, which even the government and the majority cannot simply take away. They are not a blank cheque for the majority, rulers-

only, or election-only.

21. (C) Accountability means the government must answer to the people who elected it. It is not freedom from questions, foreign answerability, or court-ignoring.

22. (A) In a direct democracy citizens decide issues themselves. Not voting, obeying a king, or letting a few decide describe non-democratic or representative forms.

23. (D) A referendum (Latin 'a thing to be referred') is a direct citizen vote on one question. Electing representatives, judges deciding, or a king's law are different.

24. (C) In a representative democracy citizens elect representatives to decide for them. Voting on every law is direct democracy, no vote is undemocratic, and inherited seats are not democratic.

25. (A) With millions of people, deciding every issue by direct vote is impractical, so representatives are elected. Citizens do have opinions, direct democracy is not illegal, and representatives are elected, not kings.

26. (D) India is a parliamentary democracy, where real executive power lies with the PM and council of ministers. It is not presidential, an absolute monarchy, or a theocracy.

27. (B) Despite having a President, India is parliamentary: the PM and ministers, drawn from Parliament, hold real executive power and need the Lok Sabha's confidence. India does have a President (a largely nominal head), is not a monarchy, and the President is not directly elected by all voters.

28. (C) The USA is a presidential democracy, where the president is elected and works independently of the legislature. India is the parliamentary example; the UK a constitutional monarchy.

29. (C) In a parliamentary system the head of government comes from and answers to the legislature, unlike a presidential system where the president is separately elected and independent. Both hold elections, and neither is ruled by a law-making king.

30. (B) Real executive power in India rests with the PM and the council of ministers. The President is a largely nominal head, the Chief Justice heads the judiciary, and there is no ruling royal family.

31. (B) The US president is elected and operates independently of the legislature. Being chosen by the legislature describes a parliamentary head; a monarch inherits; and judges do not appoint the president.

32. (A) The three organs are the legislature (makes laws), executive (carries them out) and judiciary (upholds them). The other lists are not the three organs.

- 33. (D)** Separation of powers keeps the legislature, executive and judiciary independent so none dominates the others. It is not one-person control, total silence, or abolition.
- 34. (B)** By keeping the organs independent, separation of powers prevents any one from seizing total control - a check against abuse. It does not let one organ control another or remove laws.
- 35. (B)** One ruler controlling all three organs means no separation of powers, a hallmark of dictatorship. A flag, population size and geography are unrelated.
- 36. (D)** A monarchy is ruled by a king or queen, usually by inheritance. Elected representatives, religious leaders and wealthy-family rule describe democracy, theocracy and oligarchy.
- 37. (A)** In an absolute monarchy the king really rules. Nominal, ceremonial power describes a constitutional monarch; absolute monarchs are not elected or court-chosen.
- 38. (C)** In a constitutional monarchy the monarch's power is largely nominal while an elected parliament governs. The monarch does not hold all power, is not elected, and does exist.
- 39. (D)** A constitutional monarchy (UK) is a parliamentary democracy where the monarch's power is nominal, so a king and democracy can coexist. An absolute monarchy is not a democracy, and the UK does have a monarch.
- 40. (C)** The UK is both a democracy and a monarchy - a constitutional monarchy. It is not an absolute monarchy, an election-free state, or government-less.
- 41. (B)** A theocracy is rule by religious law and leaders. An elected parliament is democracy, a nominal king a constitutional monarchy, and wealthy-family rule oligarchy.
- 42. (A)** In a dictatorship one person or a small group wields absolute, unchecked power. Shared elected power, direct voting and a ceremonial monarch describe other forms.
- 43. (A)** Kratos ('power, rule') gives both theocracy and democracy. Monarchy, oligarchy and anarchy come from the other root, arkhe ('rule').
- 44. (C)** A dictatorship concentrates unchecked power with no real accountability - the opposite of democracy's elections, rights and independent courts.
- 45. (A)** An oligarchy is rule by a small powerful group, often the wealthy. Universal voting is democracy, inherited single rule is monarchy, and sacred-law rule is theocracy.
- 46. (A)** Oligarchy is from oligos ('few') + arkhe ('to rule'). 'People + power' gives democracy, 'one + rule' monarchy, and 'god + power' theocracy.

- 47. (D)** Democracies can slide toward oligarchy when a small powerful group seizes too much control. Wide voting, independent courts and protected rights strengthen democracy, not weaken it.
- 48. (C)** Choosing rulers is an ancient idea, seen in early India, Greece and Rome. It is not new, India-absent, or impossible in the past.
- 49. (A)** The Lichchhavis were part of the Vajji mahajanapada, known for its republican assembly. Magadha, the Cholas and the Kushanas are different powers.
- 50. (D)** The Uttaramerur inscriptions record a Chola village election system. They are not Gupta, Mauryan, or Indo-Greek.
- 51. (A)** The Uttaramerur inscriptions prove India had organised local elections long ago, so elections were not purely modern, kings-only, or Greek-only.
- 52. (D)** Early republics in India, Greece and Rome show these ideas arose in several ancient civilisations - not one only, not in the 20th century, and not absent from the ancient world.
- 53. (B)** In a republic the head of state is elected rather than a hereditary monarch. Inheritance, religious selection and foreign appointment describe other arrangements.
- 54. (C)** Democracy concerns who rules (the people); a republic concerns the head of state being elected rather than royal. They overlap but differ, so they are not identical, vote-banning, or king-requiring.
- 55. (D)** India is a democratic republic: the people rule and the head of state is elected, not a king. It is not a monarchy, a theocracy, or an absolute monarchy.
- 56. (D)** The UK is a democracy that keeps a monarch (nominal head) - a constitutional monarchy. It has not banned elections, is not religious rule, and does have a parliament.
- 57. (A)** Elections alone are not enough; real democracy also needs equality, free speech, rights and an independent judiciary. An army, a king, or a lone vote do not make a democracy.
- 58. (D)** Democracy is more than majority rule: it protects minorities and individuals, follows a constitution, and limits power through separation of powers. The majority cannot simply vote away fundamental rights or seize the courts.
- 59. (D)** The chapter notes democracy is the world's most popular form of government today, despite its flaws. It is not rare, unused, or the same as dictatorship.
- 60. (A)** Real power held by one small wealthy group, despite votes, is an oligarchy dressed as a democracy - exactly the drift the chapter warns about. It is not a healthy democracy, a

constitutional monarchy, or a direct democracy.